Mohammadamin Shafiei

University of Milan, MSc in Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence, Milan, Italy
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Education

University of Milan September 2023 – July 2026
MSc in Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence (Final Grade: 110/110 cum laude) *Milan, Italy*

- Thesis: *CounterPlay: Evaluating LLM Counterfactual World Simulation with Games*
- Advisors: **Mohammad Taher Pilehvar, Abhilasha Ravichander, Alessandro Raganato**

Shahid Beheshti University September 2018 – February 2023
BSc in Computer Engineering (Last two years' GPA: 18.3/20) *Tehran, Iran*

Publications

(* denotes equal contribution.)

1. *"Tracking Cultural Vectors during Training of LLMs"*
   Mohammadamin Shafiei, Chen Cecilia Liu.
   Under preparation.

2. *"CounterPlay: Evaluating LLM Counterfactual World Simulation with Games"*
   Mohammadamin Shafiei, Mohammad Taher Pilehvar, Abhilasha Ravichander, Alessandro Raganato.
   NAACL 2027 Submission.

3. *"Moral Safety in LLMs: Exposing Performative Compliance with Puzzled Cues"*
   Mohammadamin Shafiei, Shuyue Stella Li, Yulia Tsvetkov.
   Findings of EMNLP 2026; WAB @ COLM 2026; GenAI4World @ COLM 2026 **(Spotlight Talk)**.

4. *"Framing Bias in Arithmetic Reasoning: How Language and Identity Cues Steer LLM Outputs in Objective Tasks"*
   Mohammadamin Shafiei*, Hamidreza Saffari*, Nafise Sadat Moosavi.
   Findings of EMNLP 2026.

5. *"Global PIQA: Evaluating Physical Commonsense Reasoning Across 100+ Languages and Cultures"*
   Tyler Chang*, Catherine Arnett*, ..., **Mohammadamin Shafiei**, ...
   NeurIPS 2026 Datasets and Benchmarks Track.

6. *"TruthTrap: A Bilingual Benchmark for Evaluating Factually Correct Yet Misleading Information in Question Answering"*
   Mohammadamin Shafiei*, Hamidreza Saffari*, Mohammad Taher Pilehvar, Alessandro Raganato.
   Findings of EACL (2026).

7. *"LingAlign: A Multilingual, Multidimensional Benchmark for Evaluating LLM Alignment Variability"*
   Mohammadamin Shafiei, Hamidreza Saffari, Nafise Sadat Moosavi.
   Preprint.

8. *"Beyond Hate Speech: NLP's Challenges and Opportunities in Uncovering Dehumanizing Language"*
   Hamidreza Saffari*, **Mohammadamin Shafiei***, Hezhao Zhang*, Lasana T. Harris, Nafise Sadat Moosavi.
   Proceedings of EMNLP (2025).

9. *"Measuring Gender Bias in Language Models in Farsi"*
   Hamidreza Saffari*, **Mohammadamin Shafiei***, Donya Rooein, Debora Nozza.
   GeBNLP @ ACL (2025).

10. *"MultiHoax: A Dataset of Multi-hop False-Premise Questions"*
    Mohammadamin Shafiei*, Hamidreza Saffari*, Nafise Sadat Moosavi.
    Findings of ACL (2025).

11. *"Can I introduce my boyfriend to my grandmother? Evaluating Large Language Models' Capabilities on Iranian Social Norm Classification"*
    Hamidreza Saffari*, **Mohammadamin Shafiei***, Donya Rooein*, Francesco Pierri, Debora Nozza.
    Findings of NAACL (2025).

12. *"Not All Jokes Land: Evaluating Large Language Models Understanding of Workplace Humor"*
Mohammadamin Shafiei*, Hamidreza Saffari*.
Preprint.

13. *"PsyEmbedding: A Framework for Aligning Language Models to Psychological Theory"*
Mohammad Atari, Yuqi Chen, Ying Li, Sixuan Li, Hamidreza Saffari, **Mohammadamin Shafiei**, AmirHesam Bolandi, Aida Mostafazadeh Davani.
Preprint.

Community Benchmark Contributions

CulturalRiddles (Cohere Labs Community): contributor to a multicultural benchmark of human-written riddles that tests whether models understand cultural context. arXiv:2610.29968 2026

Last Translation Benchmark: contributor to a live benchmark of human-authored examples that break leading machine translation models. arXiv:2609.04173 2026

Honors and Awards

Spotlight Talk, GenAI4World Workshop @ COLM 2026, for *Moral Safety in LLMs* 2026

Special Graduate Entrance Scholarship, Simon Fraser University – CAD $10,000 (declined) 2026

Best BSc Thesis Nominee, Department of Computer Engineering, Shahid Beheshti University 2023

Ranked **48th** of ∼32,000 Region 3 candidates (top 0.2%), Iranian National University Entrance Exam 2018

Research Experience

Research Assistant @ MPI, Cardiff, University of Milano-Bicocca Dec 2024 – Oct 2026
Advisors: ***Abhilasha Ravichander, Mohammad Taher Pilehvar, Alessandro Raganato***
- Built CounterPlay (MSc thesis), testing whether LLMs adapt when the rules of familiar games change.
- Built TruthTrap: true but misleading hints derail LLM answers, in English and Farsi (EACL Findings 2026).

Research Assistant @ University of Washington Jan 2025 – Jul 2026
Advisors: ***Yulia Tsvetkov, Shuyue Stella Li***
- Studied whether LLMs stay fair in moral dilemmas when a person's identity is implied rather than stated.
- Showed that hiding it leads to more harmful decisions (*performative compliance*), EMNLP Findings 2026.

Research Assistant @ University of Sheffield Jan 2025 – Jul 2026
Advisor: ***Nafise Sadat Moosavi***
- Built MultiHoax, multi hop false premise questions across seven countries (ACL Findings 2025).
- Showed that "more" or "less" in a question steers LLM math answers (EMNLP Findings 2026).
- Studied dehumanization detection (EMNLP 2025) and safety alignment across languages (LingAlign).

Research Assistant @ Polimi, MilaNLP (Bocconi University) Jul 2024 – Mar 2025
Advisors: ***Debora Nozza, Francesco Pierri, Donya Rooein***
- Built the first Farsi dataset of Iranian social norms and evaluated LLMs on it (NAACL Findings 2025).
- Measured gender bias of language models in Farsi (GeBNLP @ ACL 2025).

Work Experience

AI Engineer Feb 2026 – Jun 2026
Reddoak
- Developing AI agents that help people with the driving license tests, providing personalized content for each student.
- Integrated the AI agents with the company's mobile application, enabling users to interact with the AI through a user-friendly interface.
- Helped with the development of a new AI-based feature that takes images of ID cards as input and verifies their authenticity.

Machine Learning Engineer Jun 2023 – Sep 2023
Freelance
- Built an AI financial assistant with ChatGPT using prompt engineering, language detection models, and extractors to help users buy/sell coins, get a summary of the news, etc.

Software Engineer Feb 2023 – Jun 2023
Behsa Co.
- Implemented an API and pipeline for real-time KPI tracking using Spring and Apache nifi framework that reports on the performance of the system.

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant @ Shahid Beheshti University

- Embedded and Real-time Systems (**Team Leader**) – 2 Semesters
- Computational Intelligence (Introduction to Machine Learning) – 1 Semester
- Fundamentals of Robotics (**Team Leader**) – 1 Semester
- Microprocessors and Assembly Language (**Team Leader**) – 3 Semesters
- Computer Architecture (**Team Leader**) – 2 Semesters
- Logic Circuits – 1 Semester
- Principles of Algorithms – 1 Semester

Student Tutor @ University of Milan

Technical Skills

Libraries: Keras, TensorFlow, PyTorch, Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-Learn, LangChain
Languages: Persian (native), English (fluent), Italian (A2)

Selected Courses

Graduate: Sociology of AI (4/4), Principles of Social Psychology for AI Design (4/4), Logic for AI (4/4), Math for AI (4/4), NLP (4/4), Machine Learning (4/4), AI, Ethics, and Law (4/4), Deep Learning – during BSc (4/4)
Undergraduate: Fundamentals of Computer Vision (4/4), Fundamentals of Robotics (4/4), Embedded and Real-time Systems (4/4), Internet Engineering (4/4), Artificial Intelligence and Expert Systems (4/4), Microprocessors and Assembly Language (4/4), Computer Architecture (4/4)

Professional Services

Area Chair: EMNLP 26

Reviewer

- **Conferences**: ARR 26, AAAI 26 (Program Committee), NeurIPS 25 (Ethics Reviewer)
- **Workshops**: GeBNLP at AACL 26, WASSA at EACL 26, SWR at ACL 25, WOAH at ACL 25, GeBNLP at ACL 25, Social Sim at COLM 25, SoLaR at COLM 25, AIA at COLM 25